

WORKED EXAMPLES • SEPTEMBER 2026 • FRAME 3

A School System Pauses Student AI



Example 1 of 4, teacher-facing. As reported by Chalkbeat, CNN, CBS New York and The 74, September 2, 2026. Summary in our own words; no figures.

THE STORY

New York City's public school system announced a new rule about generative AI, the kind of tool that writes text or makes images from a prompt. Under the rule, students from kindergarten through eighth grade will not use these tools for schoolwork this school year. Officials described the pause as lasting one school year. High schools get a different plan. Some high schools will try out approved AI tools in pilot programs. High school students will also take AI literacy lessons every year. The system is the largest in the country, so the rule reaches a very large number of students.

FRAME 3 FILLED IN • WRITE THE RULE — as a strong student would

Story: *A big city's public schools pause student use of generative AI through grade 8*

Where I saw it: *Chalkbeat, then CNN* **Date:** *Sept. 2026*

The question the rule has to answer: *Should students below high school use generative AI for schoolwork, and on what terms?*

RULE	WHO IT HELPS	WHO IT HURTS	WHAT IT COSTS
Strict: no generative AI for any schoolwork through grade 8.	<i>Teachers, who know the work is the student's own</i>	<i>Students who would learn the tool safely with a teacher</i>	<i>Freedom</i>
Loose: anyone may use AI if they write "AI helped" on the work.	<i>Honest students; curious ones</i>	<i>Teachers, who can't check it</i>	<i>Teacher time</i>
Middle: AI only for tasks a teacher picks, in class, teacher watching.	<i>Students, who learn it with a guide</i>	<i>Teachers, who must plan every use</i>	<i>Class time</i>
Creative: pass an AI literacy lesson first; use unlocks after.	<i>Everyone learns where AI goes wrong before using it</i>	<i>Students who fail the check and have to wait</i>	<i>Time to teach it</i>

My 3-rule policy: *Lesson first (Creative) · then approved tasks only, in class (Middle) · always say when AI helped (Loose).*

Defend one rule, three sentences: *The rule is: pass an AI literacy lesson before you may use the tool. It matters because a tool you don't understand can make up facts, and you would never know. We know this works because the story's own high school plan pairs the pilots with AI lessons every year: the tool and the training arrive together.*

So what? *I'm in this grade band. Whether I learn AI at school or only on my own depends on a rule like this one.*

Why this frame: the story is a school system setting a rule, so the question is "what should the rule be", not "who was right". Frame 3 keeps students off the officeholders and on the grid, where every rule has a cost.

WORKED EXAMPLES • SEPTEMBER 2026 • FRAME 7

Musicians Sue an AI Music Company



Example 2 of 4, teacher-facing. As reported by Billboard, Rolling Stone, Variety and The Hollywood Reporter, August 31, 2026. Summary in our own words; every claim in the case is alleged.

THE STORY

A group of musicians filed a lawsuit against Suno, a company whose AI tool generates songs from a text prompt. They filed it as a proposed class action, which means they are asking to speak for many other musicians with the same complaint. The musicians allege that the tool can imitate a real artist's style and identity, meaning things like a voice or a name, without permission. A lawsuit is a list of claims that a court has not yet decided, so nothing in it is proven. The company will have its turn to answer in court. The case asks a question that comes up whenever AI learns from art: is copying a style the same as copying a song, or a singer?

FRAME 7 FILLED IN • COPY, STYLE, OR PERSON? — as a strong student would

Story: *Musicians file a class action against an AI music company over style and identity*

Where I saw it: *Billboard, then Variety* **Date:** *Sept. 2026 (filed Aug. 31)*

#	WHAT HAPPENED	SORTED AS
1	Traces a drawing line by line and posts it as their own.	☒ Work
2	Draws comics with the same big eyes and bold lines as a famous series.	☒ Style
3	Uses a singer's real voice to make a song that singer never sang.	☒ Person
4	Puts ten seconds of a hit song into a beat without asking.	☒ Work
5	Writes a story with the same plot as a famous book. Only the names change.	☒ Work
6	Makes a video where a real athlete's face says words they never said.	☒ Person
7	Cooks a dish "in the style of" a famous chef and sells it.	☒ Style
8	Learns a dance from a video and does it at the talent show.	☒ Work
9	<i>An AI tool makes a new song that sounds like a real singer's voice and style (the copying the musicians allege).</i>	☒ Person

Where I draw the line: *Copying a style is fine when you make something new in it and anyone can hear it's yours. It crosses the line when you copy a person: a voice, a face or a name isn't a style anyone can learn. It's them.*

So what? *I make beats and post covers. Knowing which kind of copying I'm doing is the difference between a style I learned and a person I took.*

Why this frame: a lawsuit about copying is a sorting problem before it is a verdict. Frame 7 lets students sort work, style and person without deciding the case, which no court has done either; every claim stays "alleged".

WORKED EXAMPLES • SEPTEMBER 2026 • FRAME 4

A Free Game-Data Site Changes Hands



Example 3 of 4, teacher-facing. As reported by Engadget, PC Gamer, Kotaku and heise, September 2, 2026. Summary in our own words; the owner is not named.

THE STORY

SteamDB is a free website that tracks information about games sold on Steam, such as price changes and how many people are playing. For years it was run by one person, mostly alone. That owner said running the site had led to burnout. The site was sold to the company that owns Nexus Mods, a large site where players share game modifications. The sale price was not made public. The new owner promised the site would stay free, with no ads and no paywall. Free sites still cost money to run, so fans asked the obvious question: if it stays free, who pays?

Q FRAME 4 FILLED IN • WHO PAYS FOR FREE? — as a strong student would

Story: A free site that tracks Steam games is sold after its solo owner burns out

Where I saw it: PC Gamer, then Engadget **Date:** Sept. 2026

The free thing: SteamDB, a free site that tracks prices and player counts for Steam games. It costs servers, and the person or team who keeps it running.

WAY TO PAY THE BILLS	ONE GAIN FOR USERS	ONE LOSS FOR USERS	PICK
Donations	No ads. Nobody owns the site but the people who use it.	When donations dip, so does the site. One tired owner again.	☐
Ads	Free for everyone, for good.	Slower pages, tracking, and ads that look like data.	☐
Membership	Steady money. The site can hire help.	The best features go behind a wall. Broke players lose them.	☐
One sponsor	The bills are covered at once.	One company could lean on what the site shows about its rivals.	☐
Sell it	A whole team instead of one person. No burnout.	The new owner can change the promise later.	☒

Why I picked it: I'd pick Sell it because the gain is a team instead of one tired person. I can live with the loss because the promise of no ads and no paywall was made in public, and players will hold the new owner to it.

So what? Half the apps I use are free. Someone pays for every one of them, and I want to know which loss is the one I'm paying.

Why this frame: a free thing changing owners is Frame 4's whole question: if it's free, who pays? The funding grid turns one sale into five choices, and each choice has a loss the student has to name.

WORKED EXAMPLES • SEPTEMBER 2026 • FRAME 9

An AI Helper Can Act on Your Photos



Example 4 of 4, teacher-facing. As reported by 9to5Google, TechCrunch and PetaPixel, September 3, 2026. Summary in our own words; the kind of capability, not product tiers.

THE STORY

Google announced that Gemini, its AI assistant, can now act inside a person's Google Photos library. Reports described it as an agent, which means a tool that carries out tasks for you rather than only telling you how. A user can ask it to find the photos they describe and take actions on them, and it does the steps. Some actions in a photo library are easy to undo; others, like deleting or sharing, are not. A photo library holds a lot about a person: faces, places, dates. That is why a helper that can act on it needs clear limits, and why this story fits a permission slip.

Q FRAME 9 FILLED IN • PERMISSION SLIP — as a strong student would

Story: *An AI assistant can now act inside a person's photo library*

Where I saw it: *TechCrunch, then 9to5Google* **Date:** *Sept. 2026*

THE AI HELPER COULD...	MY CHOICE	MY REASON — BECAUSE IT COULD...
1. Read all my messages to find one.	Check first	<i>read things I never meant it to see.</i>
2. Delete photos it thinks are blurry.	Check first	<i>call my favorite photo blurry, and deleted is gone.</i>
3. Send a message to a friend, as me.	Deny	<i>say something in my name I would never say.</i>
4. Buy something with a saved card.	Deny	<i>spend money I can't get back.</i>
5. Change a password.	Deny	<i>lock me out of my own account.</i>
6. Post to my account.	Check first	<i>post something public that's hard to take back.</i>
7. Sort my photos into albums.	Allow	<i>only move things, and I can move them back.</i>
8. Share my location with a contact.	Deny	<i>tell someone where I am, and safety has no undo.</i>

The risky combo: *Rows 1 and 3 are fine alone: finding a message for me, sending a message I asked for. Together they could read a private message and answer it as me before I ever saw it.*

So what? *My photos app already knows my face, my friends and where I've been. A helper that can act on all of that needs my rules, not its own.*

Why this frame: an assistant that can act on a photo library is exactly what Frame 9 sorts: what may it do alone, what must it ask about, what never. The story supplies the helper; the student supplies the limits and the risky combo.